

RAN ELIAHU

Assistant Director - Cloud Infrastructure & Platform Engineering

Milwaukee, WI | (414) 943-7570 | [linkedin.com/in/raneliahu](https://www.linkedin.com/in/raneliahu)

EXECUTIVE PROFILE

Transformational engineering executive with 12+ years leading enterprise cloud modernization, AI-enabling platform strategy, and large-scale infrastructure transformation. Proven track record building high-performing engineering organizations, driving AWS-native platform adoption, operationalizing Infrastructure-as-Code (Terraform), and aligning technical execution with executive business outcomes. Tailored target expertise spans Cloud Infrastructure & Platform Engineering.

CORE COMPETENCIES

- | | |
|-----------------------------------|---------------------------------|
| • Cloud Strategy | • Terraform & IaC |
| • FinOps Governance | • Vault Security |
| • Aurora Modernization | • DevOps & SRE Operating Models |
| • Executive Stakeholder Alignment | • Engineering Org Scaling |

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Assistant Director - Infrastructure & Cloud Engineering — *Northwestern Mutual*

Dec 2023 - Present | Milwaukee, WI

- Architected and delivered a Terraform-driven self-service infrastructure platform, accelerating engineering provisioning velocity by 40% organization-wide.
- Championed enterprise security modernization through a first-of-its-kind HashiCorp Vault + AWS Aurora integration, significantly improving credential governance and audit readiness.
- Directed modernization of automated AWS database lifecycle management pipelines, improving platform availability and deployment consistency across enterprise workloads.
- Partnered with executive FinOps leadership to drive cloud cost governance initiatives, optimizing AWS utilization and delivering measurable infrastructure cost savings.
- Enabled AI-adjacent platform capabilities by modernizing cloud-native data infrastructure supporting analytics, vector databases, and future AI workloads.

Engineering Manager - Infrastructure & Cloud Services — *Northwestern Mutual*

Apr 2021 - Dec 2023 | Milwaukee, WI

- Defined and executed a multi-year cloud modernization roadmap focused on scalability, automation, resiliency, and operational maturity.
- Led seamless migration of 150+ enterprise database instances from legacy RDS environments to AWS Aurora, improving platform reliability and performance-per-dollar.
- Drove organization-wide adoption of Terraform Infrastructure-as-Code standards and reusable automation modules, eliminating deployment friction.
- Spearheaded adoption of AWS Graviton infrastructure for Aurora workloads, delivering substantial compute efficiency and AWS cost reductions.

Senior Systems Engineer / Product Owner - Data Services — *Northwestern Mutual*

Oct 2019 - Apr 2021 | Milwaukee, WI

- Introduced self-service provisioning capabilities using Docker, Terraform, and Ansible, accelerating environment delivery timelines.
- Modernized core data infrastructure and automation practices supporting enterprise analytics and future AI platform initiatives.

DBA / Business Intelligence Developer — *Marquette University*

Oct 2015 - Sep 2017 | Milwaukee, WI

- Designed and delivered enterprise business intelligence solutions using SQL Server, SSIS, and Power BI supporting strategic decision-making.
- Partnered with executive stakeholders to align reporting capabilities with organizational strategy and operational priorities.

TECHNOLOGY & PLATFORM EXPERTISE

- Cloud & Infrastructure: AWS (Aurora, RDS, EC2, S3, Lake Formation), Terraform, Docker, Ansible
- Databases & Data Platforms: Aurora PostgreSQL, PostgreSQL, MySQL, SQL Server, Pgvector
- Security & FinOps: HashiCorp Vault, IAM Governance, Cloud Cost Governance, Audit Compliance

LEADERSHIP IMPACT

- Built and scaled engineering teams focused on accountability, innovation, operational excellence, and psychological safety.
- Recognized as a force multiplier who improves organizational effectiveness through systems thinking, coaching, automation, and platform enablement.
- Strong advocate for AI-first engineering organizations where automation, cloud-native design, and developer experience accelerate business outcomes.
- Drives measurable results through disciplined execution, modern engineering practices, and executive-aligned prioritization.
- Balances strategic innovation with operational rigor, reliability, and long-term platform sustainability.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science in Business Management — *The Academic College of Business Management*

2008-2011 | Tel Aviv District

- Major: Information Technologies | Minor: Finance